

6.5 The Reader Expectation Alignment Checklist

6.5.1 The Five-Question Pregeneration Verification

Run this checklist before generating any scene. It takes ninety seconds and eliminates the guessing that previously cost generation passes and revision hours.

☐ **Question 1: Does the emotional intensity range match my subgenre's expected register?**

Check your intensity setting against the Genre Calibration Reference Chart. Adjust upward if you are writing dark romance and your filter sits at a moderate-warm setting. Adjust downward if you are writing a rom-com and your filter is set to high-volatile.

☐ **Question 2: Does the subtext density match what my readers are trained to detect?**

Dark romance readers expect to work for the subtext, sensing the weight without seeing it clearly. Rom-com readers expect visible, playful subtext. Historical romance readers expect subtext to carry the emotional weight due to social propriety. Confirm your density setting aligns with these expectations.

☐ **Question 3: Does the pacing curve match the specific scene type I am generating?**

A meet-cute requires quick movement. A dark moment requires compression. A reconciliation requires a slower, halting rhythm. Confirm your pacing setting matches the Scene Type Emotional Template you selected.

☐ **Question 4: Does the emotional progression within the scene match my subgenre's expected arc?**

Dark romance expects sustained tension leading to a sharp crack. Rom-com expects rapid cycling punctuated by brief moments of sincerity. Review your Scene-Specific Trigger Response tier to ensure it produces the correct progression shape for your market.

☐ **Question 5: The Gut Check.**

Ask yourself whether a reader in your subgenre, scrolling BookTok or leaving a Goodreads review, would describe this emotional register as perfectly suited for the genre. Read your calibration settings aloud. Evaluate whether the combination of intensity, density, and pacing produces the emotional texture you associate with the best books in your niche.

6.5.2 Pregeneration Calibration Log

Scene Type: [E.G., Dark Moment]

Subgenre: [E.G., Dark Romance]

Calibration Parameter	My Current Setting	Matches Expectation? (Yes / Adjust)	Adjustment Made (if needed)
Emotional Intensity	[E.G., High to volatile]	[Yes / Adjust]	[E.G., "Added a spike parameter for the climax"]
Subtext Density	[E.G., Heavy]	[Yes / Adjust]	[ADJUSTMENT]
Pacing Curve	[E.G., Compressed]	[Yes / Adjust]	[ADJUSTMENT]
Emotional Progression	[E.G., Sustained tension to sharp crack]	[Yes / Adjust]	[ADJUSTMENT]
Gut Check Result	[Confident Yes / Uncertain]	N/A	[ADJUSTMENT_IF_UNCERTAIN]

Generate the scene when every row reads "Yes" or "Confident Yes." Adjust one parameter and recheck when any row reads "Adjust" or "Uncertain."